



Meeting Summary (May 3, 2026)



Attendees

Based on the speaker list and discussion:

- Philip Ogston
- Valerie Allendorf
- Larry Lankford
- Audrey Eyman
- Deven Corzine
- Richard House
- Charles Wallner
- Darlene Underwood
- Myra Mitchell



Key Topics & Discussion Summaries

1. Treasurer's Report & Financial Health

- April included **4 Monday dances, 1 Saturday, and 1 special "Everybody's Dance"** with **238 total dancers**.
- Saturday events lost money (~\$156 loss), while the special dance made a profit.
- Organization finances:
 - ~\$40,723 in bank + ~\$452 cash
 - ~\$11,639 profit from Pigtown Fling (successful event)
- Ongoing concern:
 - **Regular dances are not consistently breaking even**
 - Attendance variability significantly impacts revenue



Takeaway: Financial sustainability is a recurring concern, driving later discussions on pricing, donations, and sponsorships.

2. Venue & Contract (Wyoming Fine Arts Center)

- Significant frustration about **delays securing a 5-year contract**.
- Darlene stressed:
 - Venue is **critical to organizational survival**
 - Slow internal coordination risks damaging credibility with the venue
- Insights from discussions with venue:
 - They are **upgrading sound systems independently**
 - Expect **clear communication through a single liaison**
- Key issue identified:
 - Lack of defined communication structure slowed progress

👉 **Takeaway:** Securing and maintaining the venue is the **highest strategic priority**, and internal coordination needs improvement.

3. Scheduling Strategy & Special / Sponsored Dances

- Scheduling challenges include:
 - Conflicts with regional events
 - Summer availability constraints
- Proposed enhancements:
 - Themed dances (e.g., **red-white-blue holiday events**)
 - Community-building elements like potlucks, ice cream breaks
- Discussion on **sponsored dances**:
 - Suggested pricing:
 - ~\$350 (Monday) / ~\$500 (Saturday)
 - Sponsors may:
 - Receive recognition
 - Possibly make announcements
 - Debate over:
 - Whether sponsors can influence band/caller selection
 - Consensus leaned toward **allowing requests but not guarantees**

👉 **Takeaway:** Sponsorship is viewed as a **revenue opportunity** but must preserve fairness and artistic integrity.

4. Sliding Scale Pricing & Revenue Model

- Current system:
 - Nominal fixed fee (\$5 or \$10 depending on event)

- Informal “pay more if you want” model
- Proposed change:
 - Move toward **explicit sliding scale messaging**
 - Example idea:
 - “\$10 covers costs” (transparent break-even guidance)
- Rationale:
 - Other communities report **20–25% revenue increases**
 - Many dancers may not realize events operate at a loss

👉 **Takeaway:** Strong interest in **reframing pricing language** to encourage higher voluntary contributions without excluding anyone.

5. Talent Development & Scheduling Policy

Two distinct areas discussed:

a. Local Talent Development

- Strong commitment to:
 - Developing **new local callers and bands**
 - Supporting beginners through structured experience
- Historical method included:
 - Mentoring, partial sets, and feedback

b. Adding New (External) Talent

- Concerns raised:
 - Scheduling too many unfamiliar performers
 - Quality consistency
- Suggested approach:
 - Use trial or probation periods
 - Allow scheduler discretion but encourage feedback

👉 **Takeaway:** Need balance between:

- Supporting local growth
 - Maintaining high-quality dance experience
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6. Feedback Mechanisms for Bands & Callers

- Issue:
 - Feedback is currently informal and inconsistent
- Proposal:
 - Optional **anonymous feedback forms** for performers
- Concerns:
 - Emotional impact on performers
 - Whether feedback should be shared with schedulers
- Consensus leaning:
 - Feedback should be **optional and performer-controlled**

👉 **Takeaway:** Interest in improving feedback but with care around sensitivity and fairness.

7. Governance & Roles

- Identified need for clearer roles:
 - **Venue liaison (single point of contact)**
 - Scheduling authority vs. board oversight
- Darlene volunteered as **venue liaison interim**
- Discussion on:
 - Empowering schedulers vs. adding oversight layers
 - Avoiding unnecessary bureaucracy

👉 **Takeaway:** Organization needs clearer responsibility structure while maintaining flexibility.

8. Community Growth & Promotion

- Initiatives discussed:
 - Meetup.com group (approved but not yet executed)
 - Improved promotion strategies
- Emphasis on:
 - Attracting new dancers
 - Increasing attendance

👉 **Takeaway:** Growth depends on both **visibility and accessibility improvements**.

☒ Key Decisions

- ☒ **Delay July 4 meeting** to the following week
 - ☒ Move forward with **executive meeting to finalize venue contract**
 - ☒ Implement **sponsored dance framework (to be drafted)**
 - ☒ Proceed with **Meetup.com initiative**
 - ☒ Develop **new payment/donation wording (sliding scale messaging)**
 - ☒ Assign **Darlene as interim venue liaison**
 - ☒ Maintain scheduler authority, with advisory input from board
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☒ Key Action Items

Immediate / High Priority

- ☐ Hold executive committee meeting to finalize venue contract details
 - Done – minutes included at end of this document
- ☐ Provide contract clarifications and revisions to venue (Brianna)
- ☐ Define single official **venue liaison role**

Financial & Revenue

- ☐ Draft improved **payment signage / sliding scale messaging** (Valerie & Richard)
- ☐ Explore and formalize **sponsorship policy**
- ☐ Continue monitoring financial performance

Scheduling & Programming

- ☐ Draft written **sponsored dance procedures**
- ☐ Continue summer scheduling adjustments and themed dance planning
- ☐ Clarify policy for adding new talent to rotation

Operations & Governance

- ☐ Define role responsibilities for:
 - Venue liaison
 - Schedulers
- ☐ Consider optional **feedback form system** for performers

Promotion & Growth

- ☐ Launch **Meetup.com group** (Valerie to coordinate with Michael)
- ☐ Improve communication of:
 - Volunteer opportunities (free entry)
 - Payment options (including tipping, digital payments)

Miscellaneous

- ☐ Arrange volunteers for:
 - Collecting payments at Saturday dances
 - Greeting newcomers (front-table presence)
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Overall Takeaways

- The organization is **functioning well operationally**, but:
 - Needs stronger **financial sustainability measures**
 - Requires **clearer internal structure and communication**
- The **venue contract is mission-critical**
- Strong emphasis on:
 - Community-building
 - Talent development
 - Fairness in scheduling
 - Increasing participation and revenue



Minutes from Executive Board Mtg

Monday, May 4, 2026

Subject: Darlene Reports on Meeting with Brianna (WFAC) and Plans Follow-Up

Attendees:

Darlene Underwood, Philip Ogston, Larry Lankford, Myra Mitchell, Charles Wallner

1. WFAC Liason

- Darlene will be temporary liaison and can provide temporary access to member not on the above list, if requested in advance. While Darlene is out of the country 16 May-27 June, Myra Mitchell will be backup liaison.

2. Passcode Holders and Keys

- Brianna requested list of CCD members with the Passcode Authorization and she will forward to Brianna.
 - Philip Ogston, CCD Board Facilitator, Lead Closer 513-562-7901
 - Larry Lankford, CCD Board Treasurer, Sound Tech 937-623-0398
 - John McCain, Sound Tech 513-681-4768
 - Kurt Grannan, Webmaster, Sound Tech 513-520-0733
 - Zoey Bryant, Sound Tech 513-461-3941
- Darlene is collecting all keys to front door from CCD.
- Darlene noted that the keys we maintain are:
 - 2 keys to the storage room (located in sound closet)
 - 2 keys to the office
 - 1 key to the Dumpster.
- Darlene is collecting list of members who have combination to sound closet (should be passcode holders plus Executive Committee members). Note: Ensure everyone knows to return the storage room key to the sound closet after use.

3. Speakers

- Darlene reiterated the notes on the speakers from her email:
 - The broken speakers have been temporarily removed and taken to the audio shop for repair.
 - A new pair of speakers (on loan) have been hung.
 - When we hung the new speakers, they both had a significant power buzz sound that seemed to occasionally "surge" and become louder.
 - We got rid of the power buzz by plugging the speakers into different outlets.
 - We believe the outlets for these two speakers are faulty in some way. We also believe that a power surge may have caused the initial damage to the speakers. These power surges could also be what was causing the speakers to occasionally malfunction.
 - I will have an electrician come to the Center to examine the faulty outlets.
 - Regarding the speakers that have been taken to the shop for repair: we hope they will be able to be repaired and put back into place. If they are not able to be repaired, we will find out if our donor would like to replace them. If he is unwilling to commit to a donation at that level of expense, we would then accept Contra Dance's speaker donation. *Unless*, the speakers that Contra Dance have purchased are unable to be returned. If that is the case, we would accept your generous donation instead. Please let me know.
- Note: Brianna wants to 'own' the donated speakers and take over maintenance.
- Larry noted the following blurb from the April Treasury Report
 - Speakers: After both of the front speakers had failed, we bought two new speakers to use as replacements. The WFAC did not give permission to install them. Everybody's Dance was looking into buying a speaker for their caller, so we loaned one of the new speakers to Everybody's Dance. They liked it and I agreed to transfer it to Everybody's Dance, deducting the cost of \$229 from their accumulated net income. It is still technically property of CCD until ED decides to go on their own. The remaining speaker will be useful as a fill-in for the front center of the hall for the anticipated third line.
- It was also noted that all 4 speakers work together. Brianna was concerned that the donated speakers would not match. Brianna also wants to use the speaker system for their Fall Benefit Concerts.

4. Storage Clean-Up

- We can have both storage shelved in storage room, but no more than that. CCD needs to clean up and organize current storage that is not on the shelves.

5. Handicapped Accessible

- There has been a generous donation to WFAC to improve the accessibility of the Center. Accessibility from the parking lot will expand to go around the building to the front and includes a bathroom.
- The possibility for a future accessible snack area is likely and should be requested by CCD.

6. Contract Specifics

- This is the perfect time for requesting a 5-year contract with the 6-month termination clause (30-day for catastrophe).
- Every year WFAC will need a list of dates to reserve the facility including times of use. We should check with Lexington on Second Saturday in June 2027 (they are dancing first Saturday in June 2026). This list was given to Darlene via email.
- Do not store items on the stage, sound box and quilt are ok.
- Larry will provide insurance information for Darlene to give to WFAC.

7. Miscellaneous

- Darlene noted that CCD fiscal year is the calendar year and the WFAC fiscal year is July-June.
- CCD can use the basement for snacks on Saturday as long as we clean up when we are done.
- Charles asked if CCD could use the WFAC mailing address for business use as we have done in the past. Darlene will ask Brianna.
- CCD also would like to ask if we can put lost items of value in the envelope slot of WFAC office.